

Q) What is the New Vision of India-Pacific unveiled by Japanese PM on Indian Soil?

What is the role of India in this new vision?

- The new vision has been unveiled in March 2023
w/c mentions India as Indispensable Partners.

• Context of this Vision! -

- Context is about evolving World Order.
A/c to the Vision, World is at a critical historical Juncture.

What is this Juncture? -

i) The Old world order i.e. the liberal World Order has been challenged by assertive China and aggressive Russia.

a) Violation of the rule of law.

b) Threat to Human Rights and democracy.

c) Challenged to Multi-lateralism (UNSC, WTO).

Surprisingly world is not united. There is a lack of Uniform response towards the violation of such norms. Thus, there is a question mark on the legitimacy of Existing World order, dominated by the West, w/c is not seen as inclusive from the perspective of the Countries of 'Global South'.

② There is a shift of Power from West to East. There is a rise of countries of the developing world w/c do not see the existing Order just from their perspective. & in a position to address their developmental & security Challenges.

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③ The world has become all the more complex. (intanglement of issues.)
For Ex — Crisis in Ukraine has got linked with Energy Security, Food Security. It will also have an impact on addressing the Global Challenges like Climate Change, Cyber Threats & so on.

Hence, the objective behind the New vision is to develop the New Consensus. Despite the Fact, Challenges are increasing "Guiding Perspective is missing". It means what should be the vision for the New World Order.

What is New & Why New Vision is needed? —

The idea of Indo-Pacific is existing since 2007, but we need to give Concrete Shape.

What else is new? —

New Challenges have Emerged w/c also needs to be address. Thus, updating the vision.

Whether the New Vision is entirely New? —

No, the Fundamentals remains the same.

The ~~Fundamentals~~ of the Vision of FOIP (Free & Open Indo-Pacific)

i) Protection of Freedom — Protection of Human Rights, Democracy, Navigation on High seas but not it also includes stable skies.

2nd Vision :-

- ① Rule of law — Respecting US Charter, US Convention of laws on Seas, WTO Norms.

The original vision of ~~Free~~ Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP) as given by Japan to create an arch of Peace and Prosperity.

The New Vision will emphasise also on inclusiveness — means we don't support exclusions or dividing the world into rival camps.

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New Vision neither support Unipolar world nor bi-polar & even Multi-Polar. It will be based on Equality of Status, respecting diversity, putting Emphasis on Human dignity.

Japan's New Vision has convergence with India's vision of Cosmopolitan World Order, Unity in Diversity, respecting Sovereignty, Promoting Sustainable Development & Inclusive Growth.

It is to be noted that presently, Japan is heading the Presidency of G-7 & India G-20.

Both the Platforms are not just about defining the direction of Economy, but the mandate has become broad (Geo-Political issues), and it's a Golden opportunity to work together to get the consensus. Thus it's an opportunity to reflect on the Current Challenges in Globalisation and to determine Future Pathways.

In his speech, he (Kishida) has highlighted the features of New Vision.

There are 4 Pillars :-

- i) A Clear Demonstration of the concept as a Guiding Perspective.
- ii) Taking steps to realise the objective.
- iii) In Corporate, New issues like - Climate Change, Health & Cyber Security.
- iv) Consolidate the existing measures.
 - a) Connectivity Project.
 - b) Maritime Security.

As far as Japanese P.M.'s Vision, the New Concept should be People Centric.

- Connectivity Projects should be Multi-layered. It means Digital & Undersea.
- There will be focus on knowledge sharing.
- Strengthening Maritime domain awareness.
- Japan will contribute in providing Patrolling ships and Equipments.
- There will be Re-structuring of Official Development assistance of Japan. Japan will make to mobilise more than \$ 75 bn by PPP for infrastructure development in the Region by 2030.
- Japan has appreciated India's vision on Indo-Pacific, which was expressed in 2018 in the speech of P.M. Modi at Shangri-la Dialogue. The two key elements of the vision were :-
 - a) ASEAN Centrality.
 - b) Inclusive Architecture.

Japan has also appreciated Indo-Pacific Ocean Initiative launched by India in 2019 at East Asia Summit.

Japan looks for Development Partnership with India in the Developing World, some of the focus areas will be —

- i) Africa.
- ii) ASEAN Region.
- iii) South Asia — (North East Connecting the bay of Bengal).

Thus, the New Vision aims to bring together resurgent Japan and Vibrant India.

* INDIA And Major Powers *

What is India's Grand Strategy to deal with major powers ? -

Discuss the relevance of Non-Alignment as a Foreign Policy option in Present situations ? -

The Grand idea pursued by India in its relations with Great Powers have been Non-Alignment.

Not becoming a member of any block or pole, reserving its Freedom of Choice / Strategic Autonomy.

Origin of Non-Alignment :-

- In Formal sense, the credit for inventing the idea goes to India's 1st P.M. who was also the 1st Foreign Minister. However, Pt. Nehru never acknowledged that it was his creation.

Pt. Nehru held that origin of Non-Alignment is rooted in India's history and Culture.

It means! -

i) India is one of the longest surviving civilisation, has a distinct identity of its own. Hence, India is too big, too proud to be a junior partner of any other state.

India will strive for getting its Rightfull place in International Comity of Nations. Hence it can't play

"Second Fiddle".

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ii) Non-Alignment was described by Nehru as a Policy of staying away from Military blocks.

Thus, the objective was to promote Peace and to dilute the bipolarity.

The policy of Non-Alignment has its root in the Indian tradition of Peaceful Co-existence.

The Concept of Non-Alignment has been India's Contribution towards the theory & practise of International Politics.

Uptil now, the Common sense in International Politics was "BOP". (Balance of Power)

Thus, Non-Alignment is India's innovative idea, and to large extent India was successful in getting legitimacy to the idea. Many other countries of the Post Colonial World also adopted India's World view or India's way.

Thus, Non-Alignment also evolved as a NAM.

Reflecting the Consensus of the Countries of 3rd World over the vision of World Order, the World order w/c is favourable to the peace and prosperity of the 3rd World.

Since it was very un-conventional, it came to be described as — "Indian Exceptionalism". Since its principles were based on —

- i) Democratisation of World Order (even small countries should have a say in evolution of norms).
- ii) Strengthening of Multi-lateralism means liberal internationalism.

iii) Making Genuine attempts to prevent wars and promote peace.

For above objectives it was seen as India's idealism. Thus, the foundation of India's Foreign Policy / its core principles were driven by idealistic vision. (Moral Politics, Politics of Peace).

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* Theory of Non-Alignment :-

— Non-Alignment as a Foreign Policy was something new. It had no precedent. It created challenges for the scholars of International Politics.

Some compared it with —

1) Pre-2nd World War Policy of USA i.e.

~~isolationism~~ isolationism. However, Nehru

clarified that Non-Alignment does not mean staying away from the world affairs. India aspires to play active role in the world affairs. It simply means India's position can't be taken for granted. India will take principled stand a/c to the context.

What will be the Guiding Principle of this Principled Stand ? —

— Both for India's 1st Foreign Minister and Present Foreign Minister, the yardstick of the Principled stand will be —

"What is in the best interest of People of India".

Thus, it should not be interpreted as Eutopianism rather as Pragmatism.

Some scholars compared Non-Alignment with the policy of Neutrality, the way followed by Switzerland and some other Countries.

Pt. Nehru also clarified that it is not the policy of Equal treatment or Equi-distance. It is rather taking Principled distance.

India is not relinquishing the option of entering into the war, ~~but~~ if required India will join the war to ensure Peace and Justice.

Often the policy is mis-understood as India's balancing act, However, it will be a mis-understanding if we reduce the policy to opportunistic balancing Act.

Thus, Non-Alignment has become part of India's identity a signature ~~comp~~ concept of South block.

Till date, we have not been able to invent any other idea we can match the status of Non-Alignment. It has built India's soft Power. It gave India a Status of leader. India Projected itself as a voice of Peace and Morality.

We should not ignore the fact that the policy of staying away from Military blocks was not just driven by India's history and Culture but also by Geo-Politics.

Situated in the vicinity of the two Communist Giant, it was better for India to stay away from the blocks. India opted for Democracy and thus the only option was the western block.

Non-Alignment was also driven by Geo-Economics.

The priority of India and other developing countries has been to focus on development w/c required disarmament and Arms control rather than Arms race or intanglements in Great Power Rivalries.

Thus, the idea was to reduce insecurity and to expand Strategic Autonomy.

* Critical Evaluation of Non-Alignment !—

i) Practicality

ii) Whether it was useful in protecting India's core interest.

i) Practicality !—

Whether it was practically possible to pursue the path of Non-Alignment ?—

—Yes, India pursued the path of Non-Alignment.

India took principled stand for example in Israel — Palestine issues.

Even at present, if we look at India's position in Ukraine war India has taken Principles Stand & has emerged as a Voice of Reason.

There may be the Counter arguments that India could not stick to the policy of Non-Alignment as India sought security Umbrella in 1971.

a) Non-Alignment was never a rigid idea. It

b) Even when India entered into the treaty, India maintain its Strategic Autonomy, and denied Russia opportunity to establish its Naval base.

ii) Whether India could protect its core interest? —

At times, loss of Pok and Aksai Chin is sighted as a Counter Argument.

It is true that we had to compromise with our territorial integrity but the decision to remain Non-Alignment can't be blame solely. May be India had to pay bigger cost by becoming an alliance Partner.

For Ex — We can take lesson from Pakistan, w/c was used by USA for its Geo-Political interest.

Similarly, if we look at Europe w/c feels contained by NATO where —

a) NATO prevents the scope for Europe's integration with its neighbour.

b) Where Europe is paying for its own containment.

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The Frustration is loud & clear in the statement of France.